UPSC CSE Mains GS Paper II – 10-Year PYQ Analysis (2017–2026)

Polity & Governance perspective · every question mapped to Laxmikanth, *Indian Polity* (8th ed.) chapters · repeated and one-time topics both covered

200
questions (20 × 10 years, 2,500 marks)

160
Polity, Governance & Social Justice (rest = IR)

110
directly linked to a Laxmikanth chapter

1380
marks from Laxmikanth-linked questions (≈55/yr of 250)

How to read: ★★★ Must = linked to 5+ questions, ★★ High = 3–4, ★ Normal = 1–2. ✓ done = chapter you already converted to notebook notes. Question references are written as *Year-Q no.* (Q1–10 = 10 marks/150 words, Q11–20 = 15 marks/250 words).

1. Topic frequency – year by year

Number of questions per topic in each year. Darker = more questions.

Topic	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	Total
Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes	3	3	**4**	3	2	3	2	3	1	2	**26**
Constitutional / Statutory Bodies	1	**4**	1	2	2	1	1	1	2	1	**16**
Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency	1	2	1	2	1	1	1	3	2	2	**16**
Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs	2	·	1	1	3	1	1	1	2	1	**13**
Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs)	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	2	1	**12**
Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms	2	1	1	1	·	2	·	1	1	1	**10**
Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts	1	·	1	·	1	1	2	·	1	3	**10**
Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France)	·	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	**9**
Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities)	1	1	1	1	·	1	1	1	·	·	**7**
Parliament & State Legislature – Working	1	·	1	1	2	·	·	1	·	·	**6**
Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality)	1	·	·	·	·	1	1	1	·	1	**5**
Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL	·	·	1	1	·	1	·	1	·	1	**5**
Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid	·	1	1	·	·	·	1	1	1	·	**5**
Judiciary – Independence, Appointments, Collegium	1	·	·	·	1	·	1	·	1	·	**4**
Parliamentary Committees	1	1	·	·	1	·	1	·	·	·	**4**
Amendment, Basic Structure & Constitutional Morality	·	·	1	·	1	·	·	·	2	·	**4**
Speaker / Presiding Officers / Anti-Defection	·	·	·	1	·	·	1	·	·	1	**3**
Governor, Ordinances & Article 356	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	·	1	**3**
Executive – President, VP, PM, Cabinet, Emergency	·	1	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	**2**

International Relations	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	40

Key patterns

- **Asked in all 10 years:** Federalism / Centre–State (incl. GST, UTs, Finance Commission), Constitutional & statutory bodies, and governance (civil services / e-governance / Citizens' Charter).
- **Asked every year since 2018:** Comparative constitutions – India vs USA / UK / France (10 questions in 9 years).
- **Almost every year:** Local government (8 of 10 years), Elections / RPA / ECI (8 of 10 years), Pressure groups & civil society (9 of 10 years).
- **Exact topic repeats:** CAG (2018, 2024), Attorney General (2019, 2025), GST/101st Amendment (2017, 2023), Citizens' Charter (2018, 2024), ONOE (2017, 2024), Constitutional morality (2021, 2025), RPwD Act (2017, 2022), Privacy/Art. 21 (2017, 2023, 2024, 2026), RPA corrupt practices (2020, 2025).
- **Recent trend (2024–26):** more 15-mark questions with "compare with USA", "cite case laws", and judgements (privacy, euthanasia, collegium, Governor's assent).
- Questions are almost never pure facts – they ask *Examine / Critically examine / Discuss*. Laxmikanth gives the base (provisions, articles, cases); add analysis (issues, committees, way forward).

2. Laxmikanth chapter priority list

Every chapter linked to at least one GS2 question in 10 years, ranked by number of questions. "Main" = questions where this chapter is the primary source.

Ch.	Chapter	Qs	Main	Priority	Asked in (Year-Q)
91	Landmark Judgements and Their Impact ✓ done	**14**	0	★★★ Must	2017-Q2, 2017-Q12, 2018-Q11, 2019-Q11, 2019-Q12, 2021-Q1, 2022-Q12, 2023-Q11, 2023-Q12, 2023-Q13, 2024-Q12, 2025-Q13, 2026-Q1, 2026-Q12
23	Parliament ✓ done	**11**	5	★★★ Must	2017-Q13, 2019-Q11, 2019-Q15, 2020-Q5, 2020-Q14, 2021-Q4, 2022-Q4, 2023-Q4, 2024-Q3, 2026-Q2, 2026-Q3
15	Centre–State Relations ✓ done	**10**	5	★★★ Must	2017-Q11, 2019-Q4, 2020-Q3, 2020-Q11, 2021-Q3, 2021-Q11, 2023-Q15, 2024-Q13, 2025-Q14, 2026-Q11
95	World Constitutions	**10**	1	★★★ Must	2018-Q13, 2019-Q5, 2020-Q4, 2021-Q13, 2022-Q14, 2023-Q4, 2024-Q15, 2025-Q3, 2025-Q13, 2026-Q14
8	Fundamental Rights	**9**	8	★★★ Must	2017-Q12, 2018-Q2, 2021-Q13, 2022-Q2, 2022-Q18, 2023-Q11, 2023-Q12, 2024-Q12, 2026-Q1
39	Panchayati Raj ✓ done	**7**	7	★★★ Must	2017-Q1, 2018-Q15, 2019-Q13, 2020-Q13, 2022-Q3, 2024-Q5, 2026-Q2
40	Municipalities	**7**	1	★★★ Must	2017-Q1, 2019-Q13, 2020-Q13, 2022-Q3, 2023-Q3, 2024-Q5, 2026-Q2
87	Pressure Groups	**6**	6	★★★ Must	2017-Q4, 2019-Q3, 2021-Q5, 2023-Q14, 2025-Q15, 2026-Q15

26	Supreme Court ✓ done	**6**	5	★★★ Must	2017-Q2, 2020-Q4, 2021-Q2, 2023-Q1, 2025-Q11, 2025-Q13
13	Parliamentary System	**6**	4	★★★ Must	2018-Q13, 2019-Q1, 2021-Q4, 2023-Q4, 2024-Q3, 2026-Q14
92	Judgements Expanding the Scope of Article 21 ✓ done	**6**	0	★★★ Must	2017-Q12, 2022-Q1, 2023-Q11, 2024-Q12, 2026-Q1, 2026-Q12
24	Parliamentary Committees	**5**	4	★★★ Must	2017-Q5, 2018-Q4, 2021-Q4, 2021-Q15, 2023-Q16
83	Electoral Reforms	**5**	3	★★★ Must	2017-Q3, 2017-Q14, 2018-Q1, 2020-Q1, 2024-Q1
12	Basic Structure of the Constitution	**5**	2	★★★ Must	2019-Q1, 2019-Q12, 2021-Q1, 2025-Q11, 2025-Q12
75	Public Services	**4**	4	★★ High	2017-Q18, 2020-Q7, 2024-Q8, 2026-Q8
82	Election Laws	**4**	4	★★ High	2019-Q11, 2020-Q1, 2022-Q11, 2025-Q1
28	Judicial Activism	**4**	3	★★ High	2020-Q12, 2022-Q1, 2024-Q14, 2026-Q12
43	Election Commission	**4**	3	★★ High	2017-Q14, 2018-Q1, 2022-Q15, 2026-Q4
81	Elections	**4**	0	★★ High	2017-Q3, 2022-Q11, 2022-Q15, 2026-Q4
4	Salient Features of the Constitution	**3**	3	★★ High	2019-Q1, 2019-Q5, 2024-Q15
14	Federal System	**3**	3	★★ High	2020-Q3, 2020-Q11, 2026-Q13
36	Tribunals	**3**	3	★★ High	2018-Q12, 2019-Q2, 2025-Q2
46	Finance Commission	**3**	2	★★ High	2018-Q14, 2021-Q3, 2025-Q14
48	National Commission for SCs	**3**	2	★★ High	2018-Q2, 2018-Q16, 2026-Q5
59	National Commission for Women	**3**	2	★★ High	2017-Q15, 2018-Q16, 2020-Q15
29	Public Interest Litigation	**3**	1	★★ High	2020-Q12, 2022-Q1, 2024-Q14
47	Goods and Services Tax Council	**3**	0	★★ High	2017-Q11, 2023-Q15, 2025-Q14
11	Amendment of the Constitution	**2**	2	★ Normal	2019-Q12, 2025-Q12
17	Emergency Provisions	**2**	2	★ Normal	2018-Q3, 2023-Q13
18	President	**2**	2	★ Normal	2022-Q14, 2025-Q3
30	Governor	**2**	2	★ Normal	2022-Q12, 2026-Q11
33	State Legislature ✓ done	**2**	2	★ Normal	2021-Q14, 2023-Q5

38	Lok Adalats and Other Courts	**2**	2	★ Normal	2023-Q2, 2024-Q2
41	Union Territories	**2**	2	★ Normal	2018-Q11, 2025-Q4
52	Comptroller and Auditor General of India	**2**	2	★ Normal	2018-Q5, 2024-Q4
53	Attorney General of India	**2**	2	★ Normal	2019-Q14, 2025-Q5
57	National Human Rights Commission	**2**	2	★ Normal	2018-Q16, 2021-Q12
9	Directive Principles of State Policy	**2**	1	★ Normal	2023-Q12, 2026-Q17
50	National Commission for BCs	**2**	1	★ Normal	2020-Q15, 2022-Q5
56	NITI Aayog	**2**	1	★ Normal	2019-Q16, 2025-Q14
5	Preamble of the Constitution	**2**	0	★ Normal	2019-Q5, 2024-Q15
49	National Commission for STs	**2**	0	★ Normal	2018-Q16, 2026-Q5
86	Anti-Defection Law	**2**	0	★ Normal	2019-Q15, 2026-Q3
93	Judgements Relating to the Amendments	**2**	0	★ Normal	2017-Q2, 2019-Q12
19	Vice-President	**1**	1	★ Normal	2022-Q4
42	Scheduled and Tribal Areas	**1**	1	★ Normal	2026-Q6
60	National Commission for Protection of Child Rights	**1**	1	★ Normal	2025-Q18
62	Central Information Commission	**1**	1	★ Normal	2020-Q2
65	Central Bureau of Investigation	**1**	1	★ Normal	2021-Q11
79	Political Parties	**1**	1	★ Normal	2022-Q13
7	Citizenship	**1**	0	★ Normal	2026-Q4
16	Inter-State Relations	**1**	0	★ Normal	2026-Q13
20	Prime Minister	**1**	0	★ Normal	2026-Q14
21	Central Council of Ministers	**1**	0	★ Normal	2024-Q3
34	High Court	**1**	0	★ Normal	2021-Q2

58	State Human Rights Commission	**1**	0	★ Normal	2021-Q12
61	National Commission for Minorities	**1**	0	★ Normal	2018-Q16
63	State Information Commission	**1**	0	★ Normal	2020-Q2
68	National Disaster Management Authority	**1**	0	★ Normal	2020-Q11
78	Special Provisions for Some States	**1**	0	★ Normal	2026-Q13
80	Role of Regional Parties	**1**	0	★ Normal	2022-Q13
94	Important Doctrines of Constitutional Interpretation	**1**	0	★ Normal	2019-Q4

Chapters not directly asked in GS2 Mains (2017–26): 1 Historical Background, 2 Making of the Constitution, 3 Concept of the Constitution, 6 Union and Its Territory, 10 Fundamental Duties, 22 Cabinet Committees, 25 Indian Parliamentary Group, 27 Judicial Review, 31 Chief Minister, 32 State Council of Ministers, 35 State Judiciary, 37 Consumer Commissions, 44 Union Public Service Commission, 45 State Public Service Commission, 51 Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities, 54 Advocate General of the State, 55 Constitutional Prescriptions, 64 Central Vigilance Commission, 66 Lokpal and Lokayuktas, 67 National Investigation Agency, 69 Bar Council of India, 70 Law Commission of India, 71 Delimitation Commission of India, 72 North Eastern Council, 73 Co-operative Societies, 74 Official Language, 76 Rights and Liabilities of the Government, 77 Special Provisions Relating to Certain Classes, 84 Voting Behaviour, 85 Coalition Government, 88 National Integration, 89 Foreign Policy, 90 National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution. These still matter for Prelims and as supporting points (e.g. Preamble, DPSP, Emergency in answers).

3. Repeated topics – with the exact questions

Same idea asked again (wording changes). These are the safest areas to prepare deeply.

Comparative constitutions (USA / UK / France vs India) 10× → Ch 95, Ch 13, Ch 4, Ch 5, Ch 26, Ch 8, Ch 18, Ch 23, Ch 91, Ch 20

2018 Q13	India and USA are two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based.	15 marks
2019 Q5	What can France learn from the Indian Constitution’s approach to secularism?	10 marks
2020 Q4	The judicial systems in India and UK seem to be converging as well as diverging in recent times. Highlight the key points of convergence and divergence between the two nations in terms of their judicial practices.	10 marks
2021 Q13	Analyze the distinguishing features of the notion of Right to Equality in the Constitutions of the USA and India.	15 marks

2022 Q14	Critically examine the procedures through which the Presidents of India and France are elected.	15 marks
2023 Q4	Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty.	10 marks
2024 Q15	Discuss India as a secular state and compare with the secular principles of the US constitution.	15 marks
2025 Q3	Compare and contrast the President’s power to pardon in India and in the USA. Are there any limits to it in both the countries? What are ‘preemptive pardons’?	10 marks
2025 Q13	Discuss the evolution of collegium system in India. Critically examine the advantages and disadvantages of the system of appointment of the Judges of the Supreme Court of India and that of the USA.	15 marks
2026 Q14	Examine how the separation of powers is practised in India compared to the rigid presidential model of the United States of America. In this context, compare the actual authority of the Indian Prime Minister with that of the President of the USA.	15 marks

Commissions – NCW, NCSC, NCST, NCBC, NHRC, NCPCR, CIC 9× → Ch 59, Ch 48, Ch 8, Ch 57, Ch 49, Ch 61, Ch 62, Ch 63, Ch 50, Ch 58, Ch 60

2017 Q15	Is the National Commission for Women able to strategize and tackle the problems that women face at both public and private spheres? Give reasons in support of your answer.	15 marks
2018 Q2	Whether National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) can enforce the implementation of constitutional reservation for the Scheduled Castes in the religious minority institutions? Examine.	10 marks
2018 Q16	Multiplicity of various commissions for the vulnerable sections of the society leads to problems of overlapping jurisdiction and duplication of functions. Is it better to merge all commissions into an umbrella Human Rights Commission? Argue your case.	15 marks
2020 Q2	“Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission”. Discuss.	10 marks
2020 Q15	Which steps are required for constitutionalization of a Commission? Do you think imparting constitutionality to the National Commission for Women would ensure greater gender justice and empowerment in India? Give reasons.	15 marks
2021 Q12	Though the Human Rights Commissions have contributed immensely to the protection of human rights in India, yet they have failed to assert themselves against the mighty and powerful. Analyzing their structural and practical limitations, suggest remedial measures.	15 marks

2022 Q5	Discuss the role of the National Commission for Backward Classes in the wake of its transformation from a statutory body to a constitutional body.	10 marks
2025 Q18	The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights has to address the challenges faced by children in the digital era. Examine the existing policies and suggest measures the Commission can initiate to tackle the issue.	15 marks
2026 Q5	Do constitutional bodies like the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) and the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) possess adequate enforcement powers to secure substantive social equality? Suggest measures to enhance their institutional effectiveness.	10 marks

Local government – Panchayats, ULBs, women's reservation 8× → Ch 39, Ch 40, Ch 23

2017 Q1	"The local self-government system in India has not proved to be effective instrument of governance." Critically examine the statement and give your views to improve the situation.	10 marks
2018 Q15	Assess the importance of the Panchayat system in India as a part of local government. Apart from government grants, what sources the Panchayats can look out for financing developmental projects?	15 marks
2019 Q13	"The reservation of seats for women in the institutions of local self-government has had a limited impact on the patriarchal character of the Indian Political Process." Comment.	15 marks
2020 Q13	The strength and sustenance of local institutions in India has shifted from their formative phase of 'Functions, Functionaries and Funds' to the contemporary stage of 'Functionality'. Highlight the critical challenges faced by local institutions in terms of their functionality in recent times.	15 marks
2022 Q3	To what extent, in your opinion, has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots?	10 marks
2023 Q3	"The states in India seem reluctant to empower urban local bodies both functionally as well as financially." Comment.	10 marks
2024 Q5	Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at local level and bring out the pros and cons merging the rural local bodies with the urban local bodies.	10 marks
2026 Q2	"Women as a class neither belong to a minority group nor are they regarded as forming a backward class." In the light of this statement, discuss the evolution of women's reservation from local bodies to Parliament.	10 marks

Civil society, NGOs, SHGs, trusts 8× → Ch 87

2017 Q16	“The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities.” Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs.	15 marks
2020 Q17	“Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine, is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India”. Evaluate the role of the Self Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India.	15 marks
2021 Q8	Can the vicious cycle of gender inequality, poverty and malnutrition be broken through microfinancing of women SHGs? Explain with examples.	10 marks
2021 Q18	Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model.	15 marks
2022 Q17	Do you agree with the view that increasing dependence on donor agencies for development reduces the importance of community participation in the development process? Justify your answer.	15 marks
2023 Q14	Discuss the contribution of civil society groups for women’s effective and meaningful participation and representation in state legislatures in India.	15 marks
2024 Q6	Public charitable trusts have the potential to make India’s development more inclusive as they relate to certain vital public issues. Comment.	10 marks
2025 Q8	Civil Society Organizations are often perceived as being anti-State actors than non-State actors. Do you agree? Justify.	10 marks

Poverty, hunger & malnutrition 8× → Not in Laxmikanth

2017 Q8	Hunger and poverty are the biggest challenges for good governance in India still today. Evaluate how far successive governments have progressed in dealing with these humongous problems. Suggest measures for improvement.	10 marks
2017 Q17	“Poverty alleviation programmes in India remain mere showpieces until and unless they are backed up by political will.” Discuss with reference to the performance of the major poverty alleviation programmes in India.	15 marks
2018 Q17	How far do you agree with the view that the focus on lack of availability of food as the main cause of hunger takes the attention away from ineffective human development policies in India?	15 marks
2019 Q7	There is a growing divergence in the relationship between poverty and hunger in India. The shrinking of social expenditure by the government is forcing the poor to spend more on non-food essential items squeezing their food-budget. — Elucidate.	10 marks

2020 Q16	“The incedence and intensity of poverty are more important in determining poverty based on income alone”. In this context analyse the latest United Nations Multidimensional Poverty Index Report.	15 marks
2024 Q7	Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle?	10 marks
2025 Q16	Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of ‘paradox of poverty’.	15 marks
2026 Q7	Malnutrition in India is not merely a public health concern; it is also a challenge of social equity, human development and effective welfare governance. Discuss.	10 marks

Federalism & Centre–State relations 7× → Ch 15, Ch 94, Ch 14, Ch 68, Ch 65, Ch 79, Ch 80, Ch 78, Ch 16

2019 Q4	From the resolution of contentious issues regarding distribution of legislative powers by the courts, ‘Principle of Federal Supremacy’ and ‘Harmonious Construction’ have emerged. Explain.	10 marks
2020 Q3	How far do you think cooperation, competition and confrontation have shaped the nature of federation in India? Cite some recent examples to validate your answer.	10 marks
2020 Q11	Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity of the nation. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897; The Disaster Management Act, 2005 and recently passed Farm Acts.	15 marks
2021 Q11	The jurisdiction of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) regarding lodging an FIR and conducting probe within a particular State is being questioned by various States. However, the power of the States to withhold consent to the CBI is not absolute. Explain with special reference to the federal character of India.	15 marks
2022 Q13	“While the national political parties in India favour centralisation, the regional parties are in favour of State autonomy.” Comment.	15 marks
2024 Q13	What changes has the Union Government recently introduced in the domain of Centre-State relations? Suggest measures to be adopted to build the trust between the Centre and the States and for strengthening federalism.	15 marks
2026 Q13	How far has the Indian federal framework been successful in accommodating regional and cultural diversities? Highlight the role of asymmetric federalism and suggest measures to make dispute resolution mechanisms more effective.	15 marks

e-Governance & ICT 7× → Not in Laxmikanth

2018 Q8	E-governance is not only about utilization of the power of new technology, but also much about critical importance of the ‘use value’ of information. Explain.	10 marks
2019 Q8	Implementation of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) based Projects/Programmes usually suffers in terms of certain vital factors. Identify these factors, and suggest measures for their effective implementation.	10 marks
2020 Q8	“The emergence of Fourth Industrial Revolution (Digital Revolution) has initiated e-Governance as an integral part of government”. Discuss.	10 marks
2021 Q16	Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification.	15 marks
2023 Q8	e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features?	10 marks
2024 Q18	e-governance is not just about the routine application of digital technology in service delivery process. It is as much about multifarious interactions for ensuring transparency and accountability. In this context evaluate the role of the ‘Interactive Service Model’ of e-governance.	15 marks
2025 Q7	e-governance projects have a built-in bias towards technology and back-end integration than user-centric designs. Examine.	10 marks

Separation of powers, judicial legislation, PIL, judicial activism 6× → Ch 4, Ch 12, Ch 13, Ch 28, Ch 29, Ch 92, Ch 91, Ch 20, Ch 95

2019 Q1	Do you think that the Constitution of India does not accept the principle of strict separation of powers; rather, it is based on the principle of ‘checks and balances’? Explain.	10 marks
2020 Q12	Judicial Legislation is antithetical to the doctrine of separation of powers as envisaged in the Indian Constitution. In this context justify the filing of large number of public interest petitions praying for issuing guidelines to executive authorities.	15 marks
2022 Q1	“The most significant achievement of modern law in India is the constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court.” Discuss this statement with the help of relevant case laws.	10 marks
2024 Q14	Explain the reasons for the growth of public interest litigation in India. As a result of it, has the Indian Supreme Court emerged as the world’s most powerful judiciary?	15 marks
2026 Q12	What is meant by judicial legislation? In this context, discuss the verdicts of the apex court allowing “passive euthanasia” and a “living will”.	15 marks

2026 Q14	Examine how the separation of powers is practised in India compared to the rigid presidential model of the United States of America. In this context, compare the actual authority of the Indian Prime Minister with that of the President of the USA.	15 marks

Education & skills 6× → Ch 8

2020 Q18	National Education Policy 2020 is in conformity with the Sustainable Development Goal-4 (2030). It intends to restructure and reorient education system in India. Critically examine the statement.	15 marks
2021 Q7	"'Earn while you learn' scheme needs to be strengthened to make vocational education and skill training meaningful." Comment.	10 marks
2022 Q18	The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 remains inadequate in promoting incentive-based system for children's education without generating awareness about the importance of schooling. Analyse.	15 marks
2023 Q18	Skill development programmes have succeeded in increasing human resources supply to various sectors. In the context of the statement analyse the linkages between education, skill and employment.	15 marks
2024 Q11	What are the aims and objects of recently passed and enforced, The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act?	15 marks
2026 Q18	Should education be treated primarily as a welfare obligation of the state or as a strategic investment for building a globally competitive, knowledge-driven nation? Critically evaluate.	15 marks

Parliament – working, accountability, Rajya Sabha, cabinet dominance 5× → Ch 23, Ch 86, Ch 13, Ch 24, Ch 21

2017 Q13	The Indian Constitution has provisions for holding joint session of the two Houses of the Parliament. Enumerate the occasions when this would normally happen and also the occasions when it cannot, with reason thereof.	15 marks
2019 Q15	Individual Parliamentarian's role as the national law maker is on a decline, which in turn, has adversely impacted the quality of debates and their outcome. Discuss.	15 marks
2020 Q14	Rajya Sabha has been transformed from a 'useless stepney tyre' to the most useful supporting organ in past few decades. Highlight the factors as well as the areas in which this transformation could be visible.	15 marks
2021 Q4	To what extent, in your view, the Parliament is able to ensure accountability of the executive in India?	10 marks
2024 Q3	"The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy." Elucidate.	10 marks

Pressure groups 5× → Ch 87

2017 Q4	How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years?	10 marks
2019 Q3	What are the methods used by the farmers' organisations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods?	10 marks
2021 Q5	"Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India." Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies.	10 marks
2025 Q15	What are environmental pressure groups? Discuss their role in raising awareness, influencing policies and advocating for environmental protection in India.	15 marks
2026 Q15	To what extent do pressure groups, social movements and corporate lobbies deepen pluralistic democracy in India by representing excluded interests? Analyse whether the growing convergence of corporate wealth and political power poses a threat to the autonomy of formal democratic institutions.	15 marks

RPA 1951 – disqualification, corrupt practices, election disputes 4× → Ch 82, Ch 23, Ch 91, Ch 83, Ch 81

2019 Q11	On what grounds a people's representative can be disqualified under the Representation of Peoples Act, 1951? Also mention the remedies available to such person against his disqualification.	15 marks
2020 Q1	"There is a need for simplification of procedure for disqualification of persons found guilty of corrupt practices under the Representation of Peoples Act". Comment.	10 marks
2022 Q11	Discuss the procedures to decide the disputes arising out of the election of a Member of the Parliament or State Legislature under The Representation of the People Act, 1951. What are the grounds on which the election of any returned candidate may be declared void? What remedy is available to the aggrieved party against the decision? Refer to the case laws.	15 marks
2025 Q1	Discuss the 'corrupt practices' for the purpose of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Analyze whether the increase in the assets of the legislators and/or their associates, disproportionate to their known sources of income, would constitute 'undue influence' and consequently a corrupt practice.	10 marks

Election Commission & electoral reforms (EVM, MCC, rolls) 4× → Ch 83, Ch 43, Ch 81, Ch 7

2017 Q14	To enhance the quality of democracy in India the Election Commission of India has proposed electoral reforms in 2016. What are the suggested reforms and how far are they significant to make democracy successful?	15 marks

2018 Q1	In the light of recent controversy regarding the use of Electronic Voting Machines (EVM), what are the challenges before the Election Commission of India to ensure the trustworthiness of elections in India?	10 marks
2022 Q15	Discuss the role of the Election Commission of India in the light of the evolution of the Model Code of Conduct.	15 marks
2026 Q4	Is the right to vote a fundamental right? Discuss the position of the Election Commission of India while undertaking the revision of electoral rolls. Can it also examine the question of citizenship of voters?	10 marks

Right to Privacy & expanding Article 21 4× → Ch 8, Ch 92, Ch 91

2017 Q12	Examine the scope of Fundamental Rights in the light of the latest judgement of the Supreme Court on Right to Privacy.	15 marks
2023 Q11	“The Constitution of India is a living instrument with capabilities of enormous dynamism. It is a constitution made for a progressive society.” Illustrate with special reference to the expanding horizons of the right to life and personal liberty.	15 marks
2024 Q12	Right to privacy is intrinsic to life and personal liberty and is inherently protected under Article 21 of the constitution. Explain. In this reference discuss the law relating to D.N.A. testing of child in the womb to establish its paternity.	15 marks
2026 Q1	Right to privacy relating to self-identity is very dear to every human being and well protected under Article 21 of the Constitution. In this context, examine the effect of the amendment in 2026, to the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019.	10 marks

Judiciary – independence, appointments, collegium, NJAC 4× → Ch 26, Ch 91, Ch 93, Ch 34, Ch 95

2017 Q2	Critically examine the Supreme Court’s judgement on ‘National Judicial Appointments Commission Act, 2014’ with reference to appointment of judges of higher judiciary in India.	10 marks
2021 Q2	Discuss the desirability of greater representation to women in the higher judiciary to ensure diversity, equity and inclusiveness.	10 marks
2023 Q1	“Constitutionally guaranteed judicial independence is a prerequisite of democracy.” Comment.	10 marks
2025 Q13	Discuss the evolution of collegium system in India. Critically examine the advantages and disadvantages of the system of appointment of the Judges of the Supreme Court of India and that of the USA.	15 marks

Parliamentary committees (PAC, Estimates, DRSCs, financial) 4× → Ch 24

2017 Q5	Discuss the role of Public Accounts Committee in establishing accountability of the government to the people.	10 marks

2018 Q4	Why do you think the committees are considered to be useful for parliamentary work? Discuss, in this context, the role of the Estimates Committee.	10 marks
2021 Q15	Do Department-related Parliamentary Standing Committees keep the administration on its toes and inspire reverence for parliamentary control? Evaluate the working of such committees with suitable examples.	15 marks
2023 Q16	Explain the structure of the Parliamentary Committee system. How far have the financial committees helped in the institutionalisation of Indian Parliament?	15 marks

Speaker / Chairman / presiding officers 4× → Ch 23, Ch 19, Ch 33, Ch 86

2020 Q5	‘Once a Speaker, Always a Speaker’! Do you think this practice should be adopted to impart objectivity to the office of the Speaker of Lok Sabha? What could be its implications for the robust functioning of parliamentary business in India?	10 marks
2022 Q4	Discuss the role of the Vice-President of India as the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.	10 marks
2023 Q5	Discuss the role of Presiding Officers of state legislatures in maintaining order and impartiality in conducting legislative work and in facilitating best democratic practices.	10 marks
2026 Q3	Examine whether the constitutional office of the Lok Sabha Speaker has become vulnerable to partisan politics under the current anti-defection regime. What institutional changes are required to ensure the neutrality of the Lok Sabha Speaker in managing a polarised House?	10 marks

Civil services – reforms, neutrality, integrity, generalists 4× → Ch 75

2017 Q18	Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services? Comment.	15 marks
2020 Q7	“Institutional quality is a crucial driver of economic performance”. In this context suggest reforms in Civil Service for strengthening democracy.	10 marks
2024 Q8	The Doctrine of Democratic Governance makes it necessary that the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants becomes absolutely positive. Discuss.	10 marks
2026 Q8	Analyse the advantages and limitations of the generalist structure of the Indian Civil Services in contemporary governance.	10 marks

Women & gender justice 4× → Ch 8, Ch 9, Ch 91, Ch 39, Ch 40, Ch 23

2021 Q17	“Though women in post-Independent India have excelled in various fields, the social attitude towards women and feminist movement has been patriarchal.” Apart from women education and women empowerment schemes, what interventions can help change this milieu?	15 marks
2023 Q12	Explain the constitutional perspectives of Gender Justice with the help of relevant Constitutional Provisions and case laws.	15 marks
2025 Q6	Women’s social capital complements in advancing empowerment and gender equity. Explain.	10 marks
2026 Q2	“Women as a class neither belong to a minority group nor are they regarded as forming a backward class.” In the light of this statement, discuss the evolution of women’s reservation from local bodies to Parliament.	10 marks

Health 4× → Not in Laxmikanth

2018 Q7	Appropriate local community-level healthcare intervention is a prerequisite to achieve ‘Health for All’ in India. Explain.	10 marks
2020 Q6	In order to enhance the prospects of social development, sound and adequate health care policies are needed particularly in the fields of geriatric and maternal health care. Discuss.	10 marks
2021 Q6	“Besides being a moral imperative of a Welfare State, primary health structure is a necessary precondition for sustainable development.” Analyze.	10 marks
2024 Q17	In a crucial domain like the public healthcare system the Indian State should play a vital role to contain the adverse impact of marketisation of the system. Suggest some measures through which the State can enhance the reach of public healthcare at the grassroots level.	15 marks

Governor, ordinances & Article 356 3× → Ch 30, Ch 91, Ch 17, Ch 15

2022 Q12	Discuss the essential conditions for exercise of the legislative powers by the Governor. Discuss the legality of re-promulgation of ordinances by the Governor without placing them before the Legislature.	15 marks
2023 Q13	Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since mid 1990s.	15 marks
2026 Q11	Discuss the position of the Governor in the federal polity of India. What is the nature of his power while giving assent to a bill passed by the State Legislature? Is he bound by the aid and advice of his Council of Ministers in all his functions?	15 marks

Finance Commission & fiscal federalism 3× → Ch 46, Ch 15, Ch 47, Ch 56

2018 Q14	How is the Finance Commission of India constituted? What do you know about the terms of reference of the recently constituted Finance Commission? Discuss.	15 marks
2021 Q3	How have the recommendations of the 14th Finance Commission of India enabled the States to improve their fiscal position?	10 marks
2025 Q14	Examine the evolving pattern of Centre-State financial relations in the context of planned development in India. How far have the recent reforms impacted the fiscal federalism in India?	15 marks

Tribunals (CAT, rationalisation 2021) 3× → Ch 36

2018 Q12	How far do you agree with the view that tribunals curtail the jurisdiction of ordinary courts? In view of the above, discuss the constitutional validity and competency of the tribunals in India.	15 marks
2019 Q2	“The Central Administrative Tribunal which was established for redressal of grievances and complaints by or against central government employees, nowadays is exercising its powers as an independent judicial authority.” Explain.	10 marks
2025 Q2	Comment on the need of administrative tribunals as compared to the court system. Assess the impact of the recent tribunal reforms through rationalization of tribunals made in 2021.	10 marks

Simultaneous elections / One Nation One Election 2× → Ch 83, Ch 81

2017 Q3	“Simultaneous election to the Lok Sabha and the State Assemblies will limit the amount of time and money spent in electioneering but it will reduce the government’s accountability to the people.” Discuss.	10 marks
2024 Q1	Examine the need for electoral reforms as suggested by various committees with particular reference to “one nation – one election” principle.	10 marks

Constitutional morality 2× → Ch 12, Ch 91, Ch 26

2021 Q1	Constitutional Morality is rooted in the constitution itself and is founded on its essential facets. Explain the doctrine of Constitutional Morality’ with the help of relevant judicial decisions.	10 marks
2025 Q11	“Constitutional morality is the fulcrum which acts as an essential check upon the high functionaries and citizens alike… .” In view of the above observation of the Supreme Court, explain the concept of constitutional morality and its application to ensure balance between judicial independence and judicial accountability in India.	15 marks

Amending power & basic structure 2× → Ch 11, Ch 12, Ch 91, Ch 93

2019 Q12	“Parliament’s power to amend the Constitution is a limited power and it cannot be enlarged into absolute power.” In the light of this statement explain whether Parliament under Article 368 of the Constitution can destroy the Basic Structure of the Constitution by expanding its amending power?	15 marks
2025 Q12	Indian Constitution has conferred the amending power on the ordinary legislative institutions with a few procedural hurdles. In view of this statement, examine the procedural and substantive limitations on the amending power of the Parliament to change the Constitution.	15 marks

Union Territories – Delhi & J&K 2× → Ch 41, Ch 91

2018 Q11	Whether the Supreme Court Judgement (July 2018) can settle the political tussle between the Lt. Governor and elected government of Delhi? Examine.	15 marks
2025 Q4	Discuss the nature of Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly after the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganization Act, 2019. Briefly describe the powers and functions of the Assembly of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.	10 marks

GST & 101st Amendment 2× → Ch 15, Ch 47

2017 Q11	Explain the salient features of the Constitution (One Hundred and First Amendment) Act, 2016. Do you think it is efficacious enough “to remove cascading effect of taxes and provide for common national market for goods and services”?	15 marks
2023 Q15	Explain the significance of the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act. To what extent does it reflect the accommodative spirit of federalism?	15 marks

CAG 2× → Ch 52

2018 Q5	“The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has a very vital role to play.” Explain how this is reflected in the method and terms of his appointment as well as the range of powers he can exercise.	10 marks
2024 Q4	“The duty of the Comptroller and Auditor General is not merely to ensure the legality of expenditure but also its propriety.” Comment.	10 marks

Attorney General 2× → Ch 53

2019 Q14	“The Attorney-General is the chief legal adviser and lawyer of the Government of India.” Discuss.	15 marks
2025 Q5	“The Attorney General of India plays a crucial role in guiding the legal framework of the Union Government and ensuring sound governance through legal counsel.” Discuss his responsibilities, rights and limitations in this regard.	10 marks

Lok Adalat, NALSA & legal aid 2× → Ch 38

2023 Q2	Who are entitled to receive free legal aid? Assess the role of the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) in rendering free legal aid in India.	10 marks
2024 Q2	Explain and distinguish between Lok Adalats and Arbitration Tribunals. Whether they entertain civil as well as criminal cases?	10 marks

Citizens' Charter 2× → Not in Laxmikanth

2018 Q18	The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter.	15 marks
2024 Q16	The Citizens' charter has been a landmark initiative in ensuring citizen-centric administration. But it is yet to reach its full potential. Identify the factors hindering the realisation of its promise and suggest measures to overcome them.	15 marks

Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016 2× → Not in Laxmikanth

2017 Q7	Does the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 ensure effective mechanism for empowerment and inclusion of the intended beneficiaries in the society? Discuss.	10 marks
2022 Q7	The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 remains only a legal document without intense sensitisation of government functionaries and citizens regarding disability. Comment.	10 marks

4. Asked once only (not repeated yet) – still prepare

Ref	Question	Laxmikanth
2017 Q6	"To ensure effective implementation of policies addressing water, sanitation and hygiene needs the identification of the beneficiary segments is to be synchronized with the anticipated outcomes." Examine the statement in the context of the WASH scheme.	Not in Laxmikanth
2018 Q3	Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration remains in force?	**Ch 17** Emergency Provisions
2018 Q6	"Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate 'protection and prevention of degradation' to environment." Comment with relevant illustrations.	Not in Laxmikanth
2019 Q6	Despite Consistent experience of high growth, India still goes with the lowest indicators of human development. Examine the issues that make balanced and inclusive development elusive.	Not in Laxmikanth

2019 Q16	‘In the context of neo-liberal paradigm of development planning, multi-level planning is expected to make operations cost-effective and remove many implementation blockages.’ — Discuss.	**Ch 56** NITI Aayog
2019 Q17	The need for cooperation among various service sectors has been an inherent component of development discourse. Partnership bridges the gap among the sectors. It also sets in motion a culture of ‘collaboration’ and ‘team spirit’. In the light of statements above examine India’s development process.	Not in Laxmikanth
2019 Q18	Performance of welfare schemes that are implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of policy process. — Discuss.	Not in Laxmikanth
2021 Q14	Explain the constitutional provisions under which Legislative Councils are established. Review the working and current status of Legislative Councils with suitable illustrations.	**Ch 33** State Legislature
2022 Q2	“Right of movement and residence throughout the territory of India are freely available to the Indian citizens, but these rights are not absolute.” Comment.	**Ch 8** Fundamental Rights
2022 Q6	The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss.	Not in Laxmikanth
2022 Q8	Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment.	Not in Laxmikanth
2022 Q16	Besides the welfare schemes, India needs deft management of inflation and unemployment to serve the poor and the underprivileged sections of the society. Discuss.	Not in Laxmikanth
2023 Q6	The crucial aspect of development process has been the inadequate attention paid to Human Resource Development in India. Suggest measures that can address this inadequacy.	Not in Laxmikanth
2023 Q7	Discuss the role of the Competition Commission of India in containing the abuse of dominant position by the Multi-National Corporations in India. Refer to the recent decisions.	Not in Laxmikanth
2023 Q17	“Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by its nature, are discriminatory in approach.” Do you agree? Give reasons for your answer.	Not in Laxmikanth
2025 Q17	“In contemporary development models, decision-making and problem-solving responsibilities are not located close to the source of information and execution defeating the objectives of development.” Critically evaluate.	Not in Laxmikanth
2026 Q6	Does India’s tribal development policy reflect the aspirations for a socially grounded and equity-based governance? Justify your answer.	**Ch 42** Scheduled and Tribal Areas

2026 Q16	“Transparency and accountability in governance are not about controlling corruption but about creating the trust of stakeholders in the policy process by following the Rule of Law and Participatory Governance.” Comment.	Not in Laxmikanth
2026 Q17	Can the constitutional mandate of rights-based welfare be effectively realised in the context of non-integrated governance and minimal public investment? Examine.	**Ch 9** Directive Principles of State Policy

5. Full year-wise list – all 200 questions with chapter mapping

GS Paper II – 2017

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	“The local self-government system in India has not proved to be effective instrument of governance.” Critically examine the statement and give your views to improve the situation.	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**
Q2 10m	Critically examine the Supreme Court’s judgement on ‘National Judicial Appointments Commission Act, 2014’ with reference to appointment of judges of higher judiciary in India.	Judiciary – Independence, Appointments, Collegium **Ch 26**, **Ch 91**, **Ch 93**
Q3 10m	“Simultaneous election to the Lok Sabha and the State Assemblies will limit the amount of time and money spent in electioneering but it will reduce the government’s accountability to the people.” Discuss.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 83**, **Ch 81**
Q4 10m	How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years?	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q5 10m	Discuss the role of Public Accounts Committee in establishing accountability of the government to the people.	Parliamentary Committees **Ch 24**
Q6 10m	“To ensure effective implementation of policies addressing water, sanitation and hygiene needs the identification of the beneficiary segments is to be synchronized with the anticipated outcomes.” Examine the statement in the context of the WASH scheme.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	Does the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 ensure effective mechanism for empowerment and inclusion of the intended beneficiaries in the society? Discuss.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth

Q8 10m	Hunger and poverty are the biggest challenges for good governance in India still today. Evaluate how far successive governments have progressed in dealing with these humongous problems. Suggest measures for improvement.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	“China is using its economic relations and positive trade surplus as tools to develop potential military power status in Asia.” In the light of this statement, discuss its impact on India as her neighbour.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	What are the main functions of the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)? Explain different functional commissions attached to it.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	Explain the salient features of the Constitution (One Hundred and First Amendment) Act, 2016. Do you think it is efficacious enough “to remove cascading effect of taxes and provide for common national market for goods and services”?	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 15**, **Ch 47**
Q12 15m	Examine the scope of Fundamental Rights in the light of the latest judgement of the Supreme Court on Right to Privacy.	Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality) **Ch 8**, **Ch 92**, **Ch 91**
Q13 15m	The Indian Constitution has provisions for holding joint session of the two Houses of the Parliament. Enumerate the occasions when this would normally happen and also the occasions when it cannot, with reason thereof.	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 23**
Q14 15m	To enhance the quality of democracy in India the Election Commission of India has proposed electoral reforms in 2016. What are the suggested reforms and how far are they significant to make democracy successful?	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 83**, **Ch 43**
Q15 15m	Is the National Commission for Women able to strategize and tackle the problems that women face at both public and private spheres? Give reasons in support of your answer.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 59**
Q16 15m	“The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities.” Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	“Poverty alleviation programmes in India remain mere showpieces until and unless they are backed up by political will.” Discuss with reference to the performance of the major poverty alleviation programmes in India.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services? Comment.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency **Ch 75**

Q19 15m	The question of India’s Energy Security constitutes the most important part of India’s economic progress. Analyze India’s energy policy cooperation with West Asian countries.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	Indian diaspora has an important role to play in South-East Asian countries’ economy and society. Appraise the role of Indian diaspora in South-East Asia in this context.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2018

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	In the light of recent controversy regarding the use of Electronic Voting Machines (EVM), what are the challenges before the Election Commission of India to ensure the trustworthiness of elections in India?	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 43**, **Ch 83**
Q2 10m	Whether National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) can enforce the implementation of constitutional reservation for the Scheduled Castes in the religious minority institutions? Examine.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 48**, **Ch 8**
Q3 10m	Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration remains in force?	Executive – President, VP, PM, Cabinet, Emergency **Ch 17**
Q4 10m	Why do you think the committees are considered to be useful for parliamentary work? Discuss, in this context, the role of the Estimates Committee.	Parliamentary Committees **Ch 24**
Q5 10m	“The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has a very vital role to play.” Explain how this is reflected in the method and terms of his appointment as well as the range of powers he can exercise.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 52**
Q6 10m	“Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate ‘protection and prevention of degradation’ to environment.” Comment with relevant illustrations.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	Appropriate local community-level healthcare intervention is a prerequisite to achieve ‘Health for All’ in India. Explain.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	E-governance is not only about utilization of the power of new technology, but also much about critical importance of the ‘use value’ of information. Explain.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	“India’s relations with Israel have, of late, acquired a depth and diversity, which cannot be rolled back.” Discuss.	International Relations IR

Q10 10m	A number of outside powers have entrenched themselves in Central Asia, which is a zone of interest to India. Discuss the implications, in this context, of India's joining the Ashgabat Agreement, 2018.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	Whether the Supreme Court Judgement (July 2018) can settle the political tussle between the Lt. Governor and elected government of Delhi? Examine.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 41**, **Ch 91**
Q12 15m	How far do you agree with the view that tribunals curtail the jurisdiction of ordinary courts? In view of the above, discuss the constitutional validity and competency of the tribunals in India.	Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid **Ch 36**
Q13 15m	India and USA are two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 95**, **Ch 13**
Q14 15m	How is the Finance Commission of India constituted? What do you know about the terms of reference of the recently constituted Finance Commission? Discuss.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 46**
Q15 15m	Assess the importance of the Panchayat system in India as a part of local government. Apart from government grants, what sources the Panchayats can look out for financing developmental projects?	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**
Q16 15m	Multiplicity of various commissions for the vulnerable sections of the society leads to problems of overlapping jurisdiction and duplication of functions. Is it better to merge all commissions into an umbrella Human Rights Commission? Argue your case.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 57**, **Ch 48**, **Ch 49**, **Ch 59**, **Ch 61**
Q17 15m	How far do you agree with the view that the focus on lack of availability of food as the main cause of hunger takes the attention away from ineffective human development policies in India?	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter.	Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	What are the key areas of reform if the WTO has to survive in the present context of 'Trade War', especially keeping in mind the interest of India?	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	In what ways would the ongoing US-Iran Nuclear Pact Controversy affect the national interest of India? How should India respond to this situation?	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2019

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter

Q1 10m	Do you think that the Constitution of India does not accept the principle of strict separation of powers; rather, it is based on the principle of ‘checks and balances’? Explain.	Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL **Ch 4**, **Ch 12**, **Ch 13**
Q2 10m	“The Central Administrative Tribunal which was established for redressal of grievances and complaints by or against central government employees, nowadays is exercising its powers as an independent judicial authority.” Explain.	Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid **Ch 36**
Q3 10m	What are the methods used by the farmers’ organisations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods?	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q4 10m	From the resolution of contentious issues regarding distribution of legislative powers by the courts, ‘Principle of Federal Supremacy’ and ‘Harmonious Construction’ have emerged. Explain.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 15**, **Ch 94**
Q5 10m	What can France learn from the Indian Constitution’s approach to secularism?	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 4**, **Ch 5**, **Ch 95**
Q6 10m	Despite Consistent experience of high growth, India still goes with the lowest indicators of human development. Examine the issues that make balanced and inclusive development elusive.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	There is a growing divergence in the relationship between poverty and hunger in India. The shrinking of social expenditure by the government is forcing the poor to spend more on non-food essential items squeezing their food-budget. — Elucidate.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	Implementation of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) based Projects/Programmes usually suffers in terms of certain vital factors. Identify these factors, and suggest measures for their effective implementation.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	‘The time has come for India and Japan to build a strong contemporary relationship, one involving global and strategic partnership that will have a great significance for Asia and the world as a whole.’ Comment.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	‘Too little cash, too much politics, leaves UNESCO fighting for life.’ Discuss the statement in the light of US’ withdrawal and its accusation of the cultural body as being ‘anti-Israel bias’.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	On what grounds a people’s representative can be disqualified under the Representation of Peoples Act, 1951? Also mention the remedies available to such person against his disqualification.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 82**, **Ch 23**, **Ch 91**

Q12 15m	“Parliament’s power to amend the Constitution is a limited power and it cannot be enlarged into absolute power.” In the light of this statement explain whether Parliament under Article 368 of the Constitution can destroy the Basic Structure of the Constitution by expanding its amending power?	Amendment, Basic Structure & Constitutional Morality **Ch 11**, **Ch 12**, **Ch 91**, **Ch 93**
Q13 15m	“The reservation of seats for women in the institutions of local self-government has had a limited impact on the patriarchal character of the Indian Political Process.” Comment.	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**
Q14 15m	“The Attorney-General is the chief legal adviser and lawyer of the Government of India.” Discuss.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 53**
Q15 15m	Individual Parliamentarian’s role as the national law maker is on a decline, which in turn, has adversely impacted the quality of debates and their outcome. Discuss.	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 23**, **Ch 86**
Q16 15m	‘In the context of neo-liberal paradigm of development planning, multi-level planning is expected to make operations cost-effective and remove many implementation blockages.’ — Discuss.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes **Ch 56**
Q17 15m	The need for cooperation among various service sectors has been an inherent component of development discourse. Partnership bridges the gap among the sectors. It also sets in motion a culture of ‘collaboration’ and ‘team spirit’. In the light of statements above examine India’s development process.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	Performance of welfare schemes that are implemented for vulnerable sections is not so effective due to absence of their awareness and active involvement at all stages of policy process. — Discuss.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	‘The long-sustained image of India as a leader of the oppressed and marginalised nations has disappeared on account of its new found role in the emerging global order.’ Elaborate.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	‘What introduces friction into the ties between India and the United States is that Washington is still unable to find for India a position in its global strategy, which would satisfy India’s national self-esteem and ambitions.’ Explain with suitable examples.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2020

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter

Q1 10m	“There is a need for simplification of procedure for disqualification of persons found guilty of corrupt practices under the Representation of Peoples Act”. Comment.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 82**, **Ch 83**
Q2 10m	“Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission”. Discuss.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 62**, **Ch 63**
Q3 10m	How far do you think cooperation, competition and confrontation have shaped the nature of federation in India? Cite some recent examples to validate your answer.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 14**, **Ch 15**
Q4 10m	The judicial systems in India and UK seem to be converging as well as diverging in recent times. Highlight the key points of convergence and divergence between the two nations in terms of their judicial practices.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 26**, **Ch 95**
Q5 10m	‘Once a Speaker, Always a Speaker’! Do you think this practice should be adopted to impart objectivity to the office of the Speaker of Lok Sabha? What could be its implications for the robust functioning of parliamentary business in India?	Speaker / Presiding Officers / Anti-Defection **Ch 23**
Q6 10m	In order to enhance the prospects of social development, sound and adequate health care policies are needed particularly in the fields of geriatric and maternal health care. Discuss.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	“Institutional quality is a crucial driver of economic performance”. In this context suggest reforms in Civil Service for strengthening democracy.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency **Ch 75**
Q8 10m	“The emergence of Fourth Industrial Revolution (Digital Revolution) has initiated e-Governance as an integral part of government”. Discuss.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	Critically examine the role of WHO in providing global health security during the Covid-19 pandemic.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	‘Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries’. Comment with examples.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity of the nation. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897; The Disaster Management Act, 2005 and recently passed Farm Acts.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 14**, **Ch 15**, **Ch 68**

Q12 15m	Judicial Legislation is antithetical to the doctrine of separation of powers as envisaged in the Indian Constitution. In this context justify the filing of large number of public interest petitions praying for issuing guidelines to executive authorities.	Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL **Ch 28**, **Ch 29**
Q13 15m	The strength and sustenance of local institutions in India has shifted from their formative phase of 'Functions, Functionaries and Funds' to the contemporary stage of 'Functionality'. Highlight the critical challenges faced by local institutions in terms of their functionality in recent times.	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**
Q14 15m	Rajya Sabha has been transformed from a 'useless stepney tyre' to the most useful supporting organ in past few decades. Highlight the factors as well as the areas in which this transformation could be visible.	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 23**
Q15 15m	Which steps are required for constitutionalization of a Commission? Do you think imparting constitutionality to the National Commission for Women would ensure greater gender justice and empowerment in India? Give reasons.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 59**, **Ch 50**
Q16 15m	"The incedence and intensity of poverty are more important in determining poverty based on income alone". In this context analyse the latest United Nations Multidimensional Poverty Index Report.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	"Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine, is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India". Evaluate the role of the Self Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	National Education Policy 2020 is in conformity with the Sustainable Development Goal-4 (2030). It intends to restructure and reorient education system in India. Critically examine the statement.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	'Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad)' is transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times — Discuss.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	What is the significance of Indo-US defence deals over Indo-Russian defence deals? Discuss with reference to stability in the Indo-Pacific region.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2021

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	Constitutional Morality is rooted in the constitution itself and is founded on its essential facets. Explain the doctrine of Constitutional Morality' with the help of relevant judicial decisions.	Amendment, Basic Structure & Constitutional Morality **Ch 12**, **Ch 91**

Q2 10m	Discuss the desirability of greater representation to women in the higher judiciary to ensure diversity, equity and inclusiveness.	Judiciary – Independence, Appointments, Collegium **Ch 26**, **Ch 34**
Q3 10m	How have the recommendations of the 14th Finance Commission of India enabled the States to improve their fiscal position?	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 46**, **Ch 15**
Q4 10m	To what extent, in your view, the Parliament is able to ensure accountability of the executive in India?	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 13**, **Ch 23**, **Ch 24**
Q5 10m	“Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India.” Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q6 10m	“Besides being a moral imperative of a Welfare State, primary health structure is a necessary precondition for sustainable development.” Analyze.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	“‘Earn while you learn’ scheme needs to be strengthened to make vocational education and skill training meaningful.” Comment.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	Can the vicious cycle of gender inequality, poverty and malnutrition be broken through microfinancing of women SHGs? Explain with examples.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	“If the last few decades were of Asia’s growth story, the next few are expected to be of Africa’s.” In the light of this statement, examine India’s influence in Africa in recent years.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	“The USA is facing an existential threat in the form of a China, that is much more challenging than the erstwhile Soviet Union.” Explain.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	The jurisdiction of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) regarding lodging an FIR and conducting probe within a particular State is being questioned by various States. However, the power of the States to withhold consent to the CBI is not absolute. Explain with special reference to the federal character of India.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 65**, **Ch 15**
Q12 15m	Though the Human Rights Commissions have contributed immensely to the protection of human rights in India, yet they have failed to assert themselves against the mighty and powerful. Analyzing their structural and practical limitations, suggest remedial measures.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 57**, **Ch 58**

Q13 15m	Analyze the distinguishing features of the notion of Right to Equality in the Constitutions of the USA and India.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 8**, **Ch 95**
Q14 15m	Explain the constitutional provisions under which Legislative Councils are established. Review the working and current status of Legislative Councils with suitable illustrations.	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 33**
Q15 15m	Do Department-related Parliamentary Standing Committees keep the administration on its toes and inspire reverence for parliamentary control? Evaluate the working of such committees with suitable examples.	Parliamentary Committees **Ch 24**
Q16 15m	Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification.	Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	"Though women in post-Independent India have excelled in various fields, the social attitude towards women and feminist movement has been patriarchal." Apart from women education and women empowerment schemes, what interventions can help change this milieu?	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	Critically examine the aims and objectives of SCO. What importance does it hold for India?	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	The newly tri-nation partnership AUKUS is aimed at countering China's ambitions in the Indo-Pacific region. Is it going to supersede the existing partnerships in the region? Discuss the strength and impact of AUKUS in the present scenario.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2022

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	"The most significant achievement of modern law in India is the constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court." Discuss this statement with the help of relevant case laws.	Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL **Ch 28**, **Ch 29**, **Ch 92**

Q2 10m	“Right of movement and residence throughout the territory of India are freely available to the Indian citizens, but these rights are not absolute.” Comment.	Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality) **Ch 8**
Q3 10m	To what extent, in your opinion, has the decentralisation of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots?	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**
Q4 10m	Discuss the role of the Vice-President of India as the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.	Executive – President, VP, PM, Cabinet, Emergency **Ch 19**, **Ch 23**
Q5 10m	Discuss the role of the National Commission for Backward Classes in the wake of its transformation from a statutory body to a constitutional body.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 50**
Q6 10m	The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 remains only a legal document without intense sensitisation of government functionaries and citizens regarding disability. Comment.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	‘India is an age-old friend of Sri Lanka.’ Discuss India’s role in the recent crisis in Sri Lanka in the light of the preceding statement.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	Do you think that BIMSTEC is a parallel organisation like the SAARC? What are the similarities and dissimilarities between the two? How are Indian foreign policy objectives realized by forming this new organisation?	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	Discuss the procedures to decide the disputes arising out of the election of a Member of the Parliament or State Legislature under The Representation of the People Act, 1951. What are the grounds on which the election of any returned candidate may be declared void? What remedy is available to the aggrieved party against the decision? Refer to the case laws.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 82**, **Ch 81**

Q12 15m	Discuss the essential conditions for exercise of the legislative powers by the Governor. Discuss the legality of re-promulgation of ordinances by the Governor without placing them before the Legislature.	Governor, Ordinances & Article 356 **Ch 30**, **Ch 91**
Q13 15m	“While the national political parties in India favour centralisation, the regional parties are in favour of State autonomy.” Comment.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 79**, **Ch 80**
Q14 15m	Critically examine the procedures through which the Presidents of India and France are elected.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 18**, **Ch 95**
Q15 15m	Discuss the role of the Election Commission of India in the light of the evolution of the Model Code of Conduct.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 43**, **Ch 81**
Q16 15m	Besides the welfare schemes, India needs deft management of inflation and unemployment to serve the poor and the underprivileged sections of the society. Discuss.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	Do you agree with the view that increasing dependence on donor agencies for development reduces the importance of community participation in the development process? Justify your answer.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 remains inadequate in promoting incentive-based system for children’s education without generating awareness about the importance of schooling. Analyse.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes **Ch 8**
Q19 15m	How will I2U2 (India, Israel, UAE and USA) grouping transform India’s position in global politics?	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	‘Clean energy is the order of the day.’ Describe briefly India’s changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2023

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	“Constitutionally guaranteed judicial independence is a prerequisite of democracy.” Comment.	Judiciary – Independence, Appointments, Collegium **Ch 26**

Q2 10m	Who are entitled to receive free legal aid? Assess the role of the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) in rendering free legal aid in India.	Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid **Ch 38**
Q3 10m	“The states in India seem reluctant to empower urban local bodies both functionally as well as financially.” Comment.	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 40**
Q4 10m	Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 13**, **Ch 23**, **Ch 95**
Q5 10m	Discuss the role of Presiding Officers of state legislatures in maintaining order and impartiality in conducting legislative work and in facilitating best democratic practices.	Speaker / Presiding Officers / Anti-Defection **Ch 33**
Q6 10m	The crucial aspect of development process has been the inadequate attention paid to Human Resource Development in India. Suggest measures that can address this inadequacy.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	Discuss the role of the Competition Commission of India in containing the abuse of dominant position by the Multi-National Corporations in India. Refer to the recent decisions.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features?	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	‘Virus of Conflict is affecting the functioning of the SCO’ In the light of the above statement point out the role of India in mitigating the problems.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	“The Constitution of India is a living instrument with capabilities of enormous dynamism. It is a constitution made for a progressive society.” Illustrate with special reference to the expanding horizons of the right to life and personal liberty.	Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality) **Ch 8**, **Ch 92**, **Ch 91**
Q12 15m	Explain the constitutional perspectives of Gender Justice with the help of relevant Constitutional Provisions and case laws.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts **Ch 8**, **Ch 9**, **Ch 91**

Q13 15m	Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since mid 1990s.	Governor, Ordinances & Article 356 **Ch 17**, **Ch 91**
Q14 15m	Discuss the contribution of civil society groups for women's effective and meaningful participation and representation in state legislatures in India.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q15 15m	Explain the significance of the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act. To what extent does it reflect the accommodative spirit of federalism?	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 15**, **Ch 47**
Q16 15m	Explain the structure of the Parliamentary Committee system. How far have the financial committees helped in the institutionalisation of Indian Parliament?	Parliamentary Committees **Ch 24**
Q17 15m	"Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by its nature, are discriminatory in approach." Do you agree? Give reasons for your answer.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	Skill development programmes have succeeded in increasing human resources supply to various sectors. In the context of the statement analyse the linkages between education, skill and employment.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	'The expansion and strengthening of NATO and a stronger US-Europe strategic partnership works well for India.' What is your opinion about this statement? Give reasons and examples to support your answer.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	'Sea is an important Component of the Cosmos' Discuss in the light of the above statement the role of the IMO (International Maritime Organisation) in protecting environment and enhancing maritime safety and security.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2024

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	Examine the need for electoral reforms as suggested by various committees with particular reference to "one nation – one election" principle.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 83**
Q2 10m	Explain and distinguish between Lok Adalats and Arbitration Tribunals. Whether they entertain civil as well as criminal cases?	Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid **Ch 38**

Q3 10m	“The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy.” Elucidate.	Parliament & State Legislature – Working **Ch 13**, **Ch 21**, **Ch 23**
Q4 10m	“The duty of the Comptroller and Auditor General is not merely to ensure the legality of expenditure but also its propriety.” Comment.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 52**
Q5 10m	Analyse the role of local bodies in providing good governance at local level and bring out the pros and cons merging the rural local bodies with the urban local bodies.	Local Government (Panchayats & Municipalities) **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**
Q6 10m	Public charitable trusts have the potential to make India’s development more inclusive as they relate to certain vital public issues. Comment.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	Poverty and malnutrition create a vicious cycle, adversely affecting human capital formation. What steps can be taken to break the cycle?	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	The Doctrine of Democratic Governance makes it necessary that the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants becomes absolutely positive. Discuss.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency **Ch 75**
Q9 10m	‘The West is fostering India as an alternative to reduce dependence on China’s supply chain and as a strategic ally to counter China’s political and economic dominance.’ Explain this statement with examples.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	Critically analyse India’s evolving diplomatic, economic and strategic relations with the Central Asian Republics (CARs) highlighting their increasing significance in regional and global geopolitics.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	What are the aims and objects of recently passed and enforced, The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act?	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q12 15m	Right to privacy is intrinsic to life and personal liberty and is inherently protected under Article 21 of the constitution. Explain. In this reference discuss the law relating to D.N.A. testing of child in the womb to establish its paternity.	Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality) **Ch 8**, **Ch 92**, **Ch 91**
Q13 15m	What changes has the Union Government recently introduced in the domain of Centre-State relations? Suggest measures to be adopted to build the trust between the Centre and the States and for strengthening federalism.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 15**

Q14 15m	Explain the reasons for the growth of public interest litigation in India. As a result of it, has the Indian Supreme Court emerged as the world's most powerful judiciary?	Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL **Ch 29**, **Ch 28**
Q15 15m	Discuss India as a secular state and compare with the secular principles of the US constitution.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 4**, **Ch 5**, **Ch 95**
Q16 15m	The Citizens' charter has been a landmark initiative in ensuring citizen-centric administration. But it is yet to reach its full potential. Identify the factors hindering the realisation of its promise and suggest measures to overcome them.	Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	In a crucial domain like the public healthcare system the Indian State should play a vital role to contain the adverse impact of marketisation of the system. Suggest some measures through which the State can enhance the reach of public healthcare at the grassroots level.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	e-governance is not just about the routine application of digital technology in service delivery process. It is as much about multifarious interactions for ensuring transparency and accountability. In this context evaluate the role of the 'Interactive Service Model' of e-governance.	Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	'Terrorism has become a significant threat to global peace and security.' Evaluate the effectiveness of the United Nations Security Council's Counter Terrorism Committee (CTC) and its associated bodies in addressing and mitigating this threat at the international level.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	Discuss the geopolitical and geostrategic importance of Maldives for India with a focus on global trade and energy flows. Further also discuss how this relationship affects India's maritime security and regional stability amidst international competition?	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2025

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	Discuss the 'corrupt practices' for the purpose of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Analyze whether the increase in the assets of the legislators and/or their associates, disproportionate to their known sources of income, would constitute 'undue influence' and consequently a corrupt practice.	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 82**
Q2 10m	Comment on the need of administrative tribunals as compared to the court system. Assess the impact of the recent tribunal reforms through rationalization of tribunals made in 2021.	Tribunals, Lok Adalats & Legal Aid **Ch 36**

Q3 10m	Compare and contrast the President’s power to pardon in India and in the USA. Are there any limits to it in both the countries? What are ‘preemptive pardons’?	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 18**, **Ch 95**
Q4 10m	Discuss the nature of Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly after the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganization Act, 2019. Briefly describe the powers and functions of the Assembly of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 41**
Q5 10m	“The Attorney General of India plays a crucial role in guiding the legal framework of the Union Government and ensuring sound governance through legal counsel.” Discuss his responsibilities, rights and limitations in this regard.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 53**
Q6 10m	Women’s social capital complements in advancing empowerment and gender equity. Explain.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts Not in Laxmikanth
Q7 10m	e-governance projects have a built-in bias towards technology and back-end integration than user-centric designs. Examine.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	Civil Society Organizations are often perceived as being anti-State actors than non-State actors. Do you agree? Justify.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs Not in Laxmikanth
Q9 10m	India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	“With the waning of globalization, post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism.” Elucidate.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	“Constitutional morality is the fulcrum which acts as an essential check upon the high functionaries and citizens alike… .” In view of the above observation of the Supreme Court, explain the concept of constitutional morality and its application to ensure balance between judicial independence and judicial accountability in India.	Amendment, Basic Structure & Constitutional Morality **Ch 12**, **Ch 26**
Q12 15m	Indian Constitution has conferred the amending power on the ordinary legislative institutions with a few procedural hurdles. In view of this statement, examine the procedural and substantive limitations on the amending power of the Parliament to change the Constitution.	Amendment, Basic Structure & Constitutional Morality **Ch 11**, **Ch 12**

Q13 15m	Discuss the evolution of collegium system in India. Critically examine the advantages and disadvantages of the system of appointment of the Judges of the Supreme Court of India and that of the USA.	Judiciary – Independence, Appointments, Collegium **Ch 26**, **Ch 91**, **Ch 95**
Q14 15m	Examine the evolving pattern of Centre-State financial relations in the context of planned development in India. How far have the recent reforms impacted the fiscal federalism in India?	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 15**, **Ch 46**, **Ch 47**, **Ch 56**
Q15 15m	What are environmental pressure groups? Discuss their role in raising awareness, influencing policies and advocating for environmental protection in India.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q16 15m	Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	"In contemporary development models, decision-making and problem-solving responsibilities are not located close to the source of information and execution defeating the objectives of development." Critically evaluate.	Civil Services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q18 15m	The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights has to address the challenges faced by children in the digital era. Examine the existing policies and suggest measures the Commission can initiate to tackle the issue.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 60**
Q19 15m	"Energy security constitutes the dominant kingpin of India's foreign policy, and is linked with India's overarching influence in Middle Eastern countries." How would you integrate energy security with India's foreign policy trajectories in the coming years?	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	"The reform process in the United Nations remains unresolved, because of the delicate imbalance of East and West and entanglement of the USA vs. Russo-Chinese alliance." Examine and critically evaluate the East-West policy confrontations in this regard.	International Relations IR

GS Paper II – 2026

Q	Question	Topic → Chapter
Q1 10m	Right to privacy relating to self-identity is very dear to every human being and well protected under Article 21 of the Constitution. In this context, examine the effect of the amendment in 2026, to the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019.	Fundamental Rights (Art. 21, Privacy, Equality) **Ch 8**, **Ch 92**, **Ch 91**

Q2 10m	“Women as a class neither belong to a minority group nor are they regarded as forming a backward class.” In the light of this statement, discuss the evolution of women’s reservation from local bodies to Parliament.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts **Ch 39**, **Ch 40**, **Ch 23**
Q3 10m	Examine whether the constitutional office of the Lok Sabha Speaker has become vulnerable to partisan politics under the current anti-defection regime. What institutional changes are required to ensure the neutrality of the Lok Sabha Speaker in managing a polarised House?	Speaker / Presiding Officers / Anti-Defection **Ch 23**, **Ch 86**
Q4 10m	Is the right to vote a fundamental right? Discuss the position of the Election Commission of India while undertaking the revision of electoral rolls. Can it also examine the question of citizenship of voters?	Elections, RPA 1951 & Electoral Reforms **Ch 43**, **Ch 81**, **Ch 7**
Q5 10m	Do constitutional bodies like the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) and the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) possess adequate enforcement powers to secure substantive social equality? Suggest measures to enhance their institutional effectiveness.	Constitutional / Statutory Bodies **Ch 48**, **Ch 49**
Q6 10m	Does India’s tribal development policy reflect the aspirations for a socially grounded and equity-based governance? Justify your answer.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts **Ch 42**
Q7 10m	Malnutrition in India is not merely a public health concern; it is also a challenge of social equity, human development and effective welfare governance. Discuss.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q8 10m	Analyse the advantages and limitations of the generalist structure of the Indian Civil Services in contemporary governance.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency **Ch 75**
Q9 10m	“IPMDA (Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness) bridges the gap between India’s SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region) vision and the Quad’s collective Indo-Pacific strategy.” Make a critical assessment of the statement focusing on IPMDA.	International Relations IR
Q10 10m	“BRICS acts as a powerful counterweight in global governance, actively amplifying the voice and influence of the Global South.” Explain the role of BRICS in projecting itself as an alternative to other groupings.	International Relations IR
Q11 15m	Discuss the position of the Governor in the federal polity of India. What is the nature of his power while giving assent to a bill passed by the State Legislature? Is he bound by the aid and advice of his Council of Ministers in all his functions?	Governor, Ordinances & Article 356 **Ch 30**, **Ch 15**

Q12 15m	What is meant by judicial legislation? In this context, discuss the verdicts of the apex court allowing “passive euthanasia” and a “living will”.	Separation of Powers, Judicial Activism & PIL **Ch 28**, **Ch 91**, **Ch 92**
Q13 15m	How far has the Indian federal framework been successful in accommodating regional and cultural diversities? Highlight the role of asymmetric federalism and suggest measures to make dispute resolution mechanisms more effective.	Federalism & Centre–State Relations (incl. UTs) **Ch 14**, **Ch 78**, **Ch 16**
Q14 15m	Examine how the separation of powers is practised in India compared to the rigid presidential model of the United States of America. In this context, compare the actual authority of the Indian Prime Minister with that of the President of the USA.	Comparative Constitutions (USA, UK, France) **Ch 13**, **Ch 20**, **Ch 95**
Q15 15m	To what extent do pressure groups, social movements and corporate lobbies deepen pluralistic democracy in India by representing excluded interests? Analyse whether the growing convergence of corporate wealth and political power poses a threat to the autonomy of formal democratic institutions.	Pressure Groups, Civil Society, NGOs & SHGs **Ch 87**
Q16 15m	“Transparency and accountability in governance are not about controlling corruption but about creating the trust of stakeholders in the policy process by following the Rule of Law and Participatory Governance.” Comment.	Civil Services, Citizens’ Charter, e-Governance, Transparency Not in Laxmikanth
Q17 15m	Can the constitutional mandate of rights-based welfare be effectively realised in the context of non-integrated governance and minimal public investment? Examine.	Social Justice – Vulnerable Sections, Women, Acts **Ch 9**
Q18 15m	Should education be treated primarily as a welfare obligation of the state or as a strategic investment for building a globally competitive, knowledge-driven nation? Critically evaluate.	Health, Education, Poverty, Hunger, HRD, Schemes Not in Laxmikanth
Q19 15m	“India’s global diaspora acts as a living bridge, as a critical economic factor and knowledge network in transforming cultural heritage into geopolitical influence and strategic leverage worldwide.” Critically examine this statement.	International Relations IR
Q20 15m	“China’s Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) has transformed South Asia from a regional space into a theatre of great power competition.” Analyse the strategic implications of the BRI for India’s security and regional influence in South Asia.	International Relations IR

6. Topics outside Laxmikanth – what to use

Area	Asked	Source to use
Civil services, Citizens' Charter, e-Governance, transparency	every year	2nd ARC reports – 10th (Personnel Administration), 11th (e-Governance), 12th (Citizen-Centric Administration), 4th (Ethics in Governance); Laxmikanth Ch 75 for constitutional base
Poverty, hunger, malnutrition, health, education, skills	every year	Economic Survey, NFHS-5, MPI reports, NEP 2020, scheme facts (PIB / India Year Book)
Vulnerable sections – disabled, transgender, tribals, women, children	most years	The Acts themselves (RPwD 2016, Transgender 2019, RTE 2009, FRA 2006), Ministry annual reports; Laxmikanth Ch 8, 9, 42, 48–50, 59–60 for constitutional base
SHGs, NGOs, civil society, trusts, donor agencies	8 times	2nd ARC, NITI Aayog papers; Laxmikanth Ch 87 only for pressure groups
International relations (Q9–10 and Q19–20 every year)	40 Qs	MEA briefs, current affairs – not Laxmikanth (Ch 89 Foreign Policy only gives basics)

Bottom line for GS2: about half of every paper (≈125 of 250 marks) can be written from Laxmikanth + judgements. Finish the ★★★ and ★★ chapters first, keep the case laws of Ch 91–92 ready, and practise "India vs USA/UK" comparisons from Ch 95.

Question text compiled from published GS Paper II papers (2017–2026); verify wording against the official UPSC question papers at upsc.gov.in if needed. Chapter numbers from Laxmikanth, Indian Polity, 8th edition.